

Chapter 159-3

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Xu Qingzhu seemed to have slept for a very long time. She didn't even notice when the nurse came in to remove the IV needle.

When she woke up, it was already the next morning, with the sun slowly rising.

The room was warm with heating.

If one didn't go outside, they would probably think it was a beautiful sunny day.

Xu Qingzhu subconsciously raised her arm to shield her eyes, then felt her forearm was somewhat numb. Only after her eyes adjusted did she look and find that there was already a small patch of bruising.

Her skin was sensitive, and any carelessness during IV infusions would cause this. It would take a few days to fade.

When she woke up, the doctor and nurse came in.

Seeing that she was about to move, the nurse immediately came forward and held her down: "You shouldn't be moving yet. Just rest. By the way, the bruise on your arm is because you moved your arm too much after you fell asleep last night, causing the needle to shift a bit. But it's nothing serious."

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "Okay."

The doctor came forward and asked her: "Did you sleep well last night?"

"Mm." Xu Qingzhu said. "Quite well."

At least she felt much more comfortable after a good night's sleep.

Although she hadn't been having nightmares these past few days, she always couldn't fall asleep.

At night, lying on that bed, she would think of Liang Shi. She had to hug Liang Shi's pillow to sleep. Often when she woke up, the pillow was soaked. At first, she thought there was a leak in the house, but then she remembered it was the tenth floor with many more apartments above—how could that be possible?

Only when she wiped her face did she realize it was all her own tears.

Before, she was someone who didn't even bother much with eye makeup. Now, when doing makeup, the most time-consuming part was her eye makeup.

Every time after sleeping, it felt like a huge stone was pressing on her heart, the pain almost making it impossible to breathe.

"I added some sedatives to your medication." The doctor said. "The foundation of good rest is good sleep, and eating comes second. You need to ensure three meals a day."

Xu Qingzhu nodded to show she understood.

After the doctor checked her heartbeat and temperature, she stood there and asked hesitantly: "I don't mean to offend, but where is your family? Even if your partner isn't here, it would be better to have a family member or friend to keep you company. You still need to stay in the hospital for another week..."

"Ah..." Xu Qingzhu hesitated. "I'll find someone. Thank you for your concern."

The doctor nodded: "It's best to find someone you trust, preferably someone with an optimistic personality. Your emotions are still somewhat suppressed right now."

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together lightly and thanked her.

After they all left, Xu Qingzhu called her assistant and asked her to buy some new clothes and daily necessities to bring over.

She didn't ask her assistant to go back to her and Liang Shi's home.

That was still private territory that couldn't be violated, as far as she was concerned.

Life in the hospital didn't stop. She still needed to handle company matters, converting all offline meetings to online ones. She occasionally went downstairs for walks and forced herself to eat every day, but she threw up almost as much as she ate.

Looking back on it later, it seemed like a very difficult period.

She was like a puppet on strings. Aside from barely mustering up energy when working, she was always in a daze the rest of the time.

Occasionally she would see the little one in her dreams, and she would also see Liang Shi. Every time she woke up, it felt like waking from a fleeting dream.¹

Waking to reality was cold and quiet—so quiet that she could only hear the sound of her own heartbeat and the constant ticking of the clock on the wall.

She didn't know what was keeping her going.

Countless times she opened her phone wanting to contact Liang Shi, but suppressed the stirring in her heart, telling herself not to disturb her.

She must have things to do.

So she should be obedient.

Countless times she comforted herself with such words, yet every time she cried herself awake from dreams. After crying, she would feel that this wasn't good for the little one in her belly, so she would touch her stomach and tell the little one stories, comforting her.

She didn't know if those words were to comfort the baby or herself.

Xu Qingzhu would say to her: "Mommy loves us. She just has something to do temporarily."

"Mommy will come back."

"Mommy isn't that kind of person."

"..."

Muttering to herself, rambling on, and then falling asleep again in a haze.

Until the final checkup, the doctor reminded her of some things and told her not to let her guard down after going home. The most crucial thing was to maintain a good mood.

On the day she was discharged from the hospital after her checkup, she also received good news. After discussing with Lu Jiayi, they decided to jointly acquire Huayi Media.

This company's upper management had previously gone through a reshuffling, replaced by a batch of parasites, and the upper management was on the verge of falling apart.

Su Zhe was close with the company's founder, and the other party wanted Su Zhe to acquire it, but Su Zhe couldn't spare the energy right now.

In this era of pan-entertainment, having a film and television company under one's wing could not only make money but also bring a lot of other social influence.

So after establishing the cooperation with Lu Jiayi, Xu Qingzhu and Lu Jiayi quickly finalized the plan to acquire Huayi Media.

During Xu Qingzhu's hospitalization, Lu Jiayi had been busy running around for this matter.

She had even come to visit her once and expressed surprise: "Your wife isn't here?"

"She's busy." Still the same formulaic answer.

Lu Jiayi had frowned slightly at the time, but since it was her family matter, she didn't say anything.

And that day, when she was about to leave, Xu Qingzhu hesitated before asking: "Miss Lu, have you ever had a very strange dream?"

Lu Jiayi was puzzled: "What?"

"I dreamed about marrying you." Xu Qingzhu said honestly. "The scene was especially vivid, completely unlike a dream."

Afraid that Lu Jiayi would misunderstand, Xu Qingzhu immediately added: "I'm not expressing interest in you or trying to get closer to you. I'm purely asking... have you ever had a similar dream?"

The last word, Xu Qingzhu said very softly.

Almost breathed out.

After pausing for a few seconds, Lu Jiayi also nodded sincerely: "Yes."

"You've had it too?" Xu Qingzhu was surprised. "Where was it?"

Lu Jiayi looked at her and answered after a moment: "An island."

At the same time, Xu Qingzhu also voiced her question: "An island?"

Their voices overlapped in that instant.

Then they looked at each other in disbelief.

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1. The phrase "黄粱一梦" (huáng liáng yī mèng) literally means "a dream of yellow millet." It comes from an ancient Chinese story where a man falls asleep while waiting for millet to cook and dreams an entire lifetime of success and failure, only to wake and find the millet still cooking. It refers to an illusion of grandeur or a dream that seems real but is fleeting and empty. ⇐